

TERRY A. THOMAS

Software Engineer | SaaS | Problem Solver

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SUMMARY

Rails Engineer with 8+ years of experience building SaaS applications, customer-facing products, and API integrations. Focused on feature development, system reliability, data integrity, and maintainability in applications serving large user bases. Known for improving production stability, reducing operational overhead, and helping teams ship with confidence through better structure, testing, and observability.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: Ruby on Rails, React, TypeScript, APIs, RSpec

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3), Docker, Linux

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL

CI/CD & DevOps: GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, Automated Testing & Deployment

Observability & Monitoring: AppSignal, Sentry, New Relic, Honeybadger, Production Diagnostics

Practices & Architecture: Agile (Kanban/Scrum), SOLID, TDD, RESTful API Design

AI Engineering: HITL context engineering for stateless AI systems; RAG/pgvector integration

Certifications: AWS SAA-C03, GitHub Actions GH-200, Coding Dojo Software Development Bootcamp

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer at Teaching Strategies

2020 – 2025

- Led an integration audit and refactor, improving third-party API integrations by identifying data inconsistencies, reducing unnecessary API usage, increasing data integrity, and lowering operational costs
- Refactored core areas of the Rails codebase serving 1M+ users, improving system reliability, expanding test coverage, and reducing production defects in a high-traffic production environment
- Managed AWS infrastructure, improving deployment efficiency and overall system reliability
- Owned CI/CD, managing release validation and rollback strategies to ensure safe, reliable deployments in production
- Implemented monitoring and error tracking, improving observability and reducing time to diagnose and resolve production issues
- Conducted code reviews and mentored engineers, helping raise code quality and promote consistent engineering practices across the team
- Built customer-facing features across backend services while supporting frontend workflows and third-party integrations
- Applied accessibility (WCAG/ARIA) and FERPA data protection standards across application design, ensuring compliance and improving usability for diverse users

Software Engineer at ReadyRosie

2017 – 2020

- Developed and maintained a Rails application, improving system stability and reducing production downtime through targeted fixes and performance improvements
- Partnered with Product and stakeholders to translate business requirements into customer-facing features and production software
- Introduced service abstractions to improve performance, data processing reliability, and system maintainability
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to define requirements and prioritize work, delivering features that improved usability and reduced friction in key user workflows

Earlier Career:

Real Estate Operations & Property Management (Entrepreneurial Experience)

Technology Sales, Product Enablement & Business Development (Immersion Corporation, NASDAQ: IMMR)